

Succession Conversation Checklist

A structured way to prepare before succession becomes one difficult meeting.

Before the Conversation

Succession should be framed as continuity of responsibility, not replacement of a person. Ask each participant to prepare what they hope to protect, what they fear losing, and what decisions cannot remain ambiguous.

Questions for the Senior Generation

What responsibilities are hardest to release, and why?

Which decisions still depend too much on one person?

What would need to be true for you to trust the next stage?

How should your role evolve as authority transfers?

Questions for the Next Generation

What responsibility are you ready to carry now?

Where do you need education, mentorship, or board exposure before stepping forward?

How will you earn legitimacy with family shareholders and non-family executives?

What role do you want as an owner, even if you do not join management?

Guardrails

Separate ownership, leadership, board, and family roles.

Document milestones instead of relying on verbal reassurance.

Create review points so the plan can adapt without restarting the entire conversation.

Protect the relationship while still naming real performance and readiness standards.